The Vigil of Siege Perilous

Before there was England there was the throne. Before the first of the angler tribe departed the main land of the Old World, there was the throne. At the dawning of the dragons, the green and the red, the white and the black laid claim to all of the land. A single gold dragon looked on the isles and wept for their future. And so Merlin the Golden Dragon, and 33rd degree mason, came to Wales. He set the capstone in Cardiff, of what would one day become Camelot. And Upon that place Merlin returned to make a throne for his King. Not the throne he would sit on, but a masonic machine of perfecting justice. The measuring tool upon which good is divided from bad. The Siege Perilous. Those who prefer no uncertain terms in life, rigidity, habit and discipline are likely to belong to a local chapter of the the Siege Perilous.

A Cult of Vigilantism

You believe that the world is clearly and absolutely divided by Good and Evil. And the dividing line between them exacts a toll upon those who live their lives as anything less than good.The vigil of Siege Perilous seeks to safeguard Arthur's kingdom in his absence by deed and song. The deeds done are recorded in a heraldic tome called the **Y brenin unwaith ac yn y dyfodol** (The Once and Future King). Any deed one wishes to record may be inscribed in the tome for a fee of 5 silver pieces. This has made the leadership of the Vigil both rich, and sure of the rightness of their deeds (however correct or misguided they may be). Talk to your DM. Work out where you fit in this rigid religious structure. Are you a shrewd and clever leader ready to lay claim to a mayoral race? or perhaps you are a hedge knight, roaming the king's roads in search of evil to punish. In most small towns a chapter of the Vigil chooses to self police their home and help protect their region against invasion. Were you an upstanding citizen of some hamlet assigned to town defense only to find that after a day's trip to the market, the home you returned to had been sacked by monsters leaving you to seek a new start in the world?

The fate of the New World relies on you

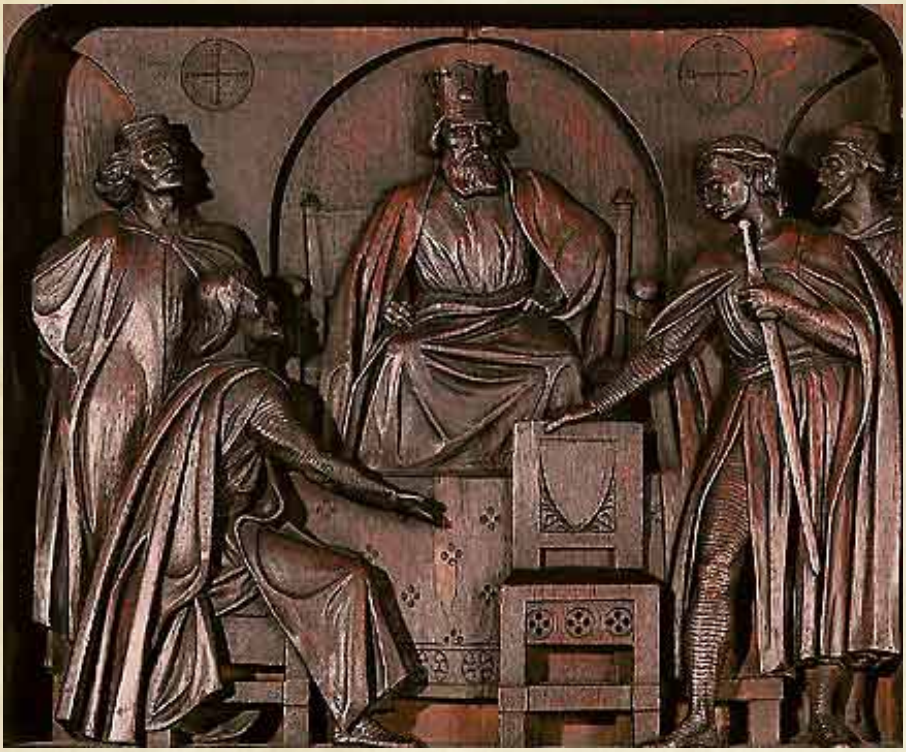
Decide the moral cause you will champion. Chastity, Temperance, Charity, Diligence, Patience, Kindness, or Humility. And a vice you wish to eliminate from the world: Lust, Gluttony, Greed, Sloth, Wrath, Envy, or Pride. Design a character with the two attributes in mind. Perhaps you are of the Charitable Vigil of the Siege Perilous' wrath. Your character would then be pleased by charitable things, and quick to stand between a raging barbarian and his intended foe. Or perhaps your cause is Temperance and the sin you wish to cleanse the world of is lust. You may be a member of the Sober Vigil of the Siege Perilous' harlot. Discuss with your DM what your chosen options do for your lifestyle and RP interactions.

d7	Virtue	d7	Vice
1	Chastity	1	Lust
2	Temperance	2	Gluttony
3	Charity	3	Greed
4	Diligence	4	Sloth
5	Patience	5	Wrath
6	Kindness	6	Envy
7	Humility	7	Pride

Feature: Arbiter

Most rural leadership rely on Vigils to keep the peace. In times of minor conflict most peasants will trust a Vigil member to settle their agreements fairly and without bias.The traditional payment for such an arbitration is 5 gold, as decreed by a clever bard's song many years ago.The symbol of the vigil is the manacles. And a member is never without them in case a threat presents itself.

Skill proficiencies: Intimidation, Insight.
Tool proficiencies: Calligraphy set. A Viol.
Languages: Dwarvish



Suggested Characteristics

d8 Traits

1 It is not permissible for me to allow my judgment become confused by emotion.

2 I have very limited patience for the bureaucracy I'm forced to deal with every day.

3 I am slow to speak, but I expect it to listened to

4 People find me messy, but there is an order to my chaos.

5 I rank my friends in order of usefulness.

6 I cannot abide anyone who does not directly say what they mean.

7 The way I care for others is by caring about what laws are passed.

8 I use my skills as a lobbyist to persuade others regularly.

d6 Ideals

1 **The Siege.** Finding someone worthy of the seat is all that really matters.(Chaotic)

2 **Order.** The law is meant to ensure Arthur's kingdom while he is away.(Lawful)

3 **Peace.** The ultimate objective of the violence of Siege Perilous is to remove violence from society.(Good)

4 **Recognition.** No deed should be kept from the siege, Good or Evil. All must be recorded. My deeds are sure to be rewarded.(Neutral)

5 **Punishment** A public display of consequences is the model for how to deal with those who cross us.(Evil)

6 **Legislation.** The laws that guide the country must be cared for by those devoted to our cause.(Any)

d6 Bonds

1 I failed to give justice to a criminal once. Their subsequent costly betrayal has boosted my thirst for justice.

2 I wish to write the laws, not just enforce them.

3 Despite the rigours code of the Siege, I believe mercy is Arthur's will.

4 I successfully convicted a murder who later escaped my judgment. I still seek them.

5 I long to sit in Arthur's chair once I have proved my worth.

6 I've modeled my career after a highly respected Arbiter who convicted my mother for crimes against our King.

d6 Flaws

1 I'm incapable of recognizing deception.

2 I seem like a harsh judge to others, but I judge myself most harshly of all.

3 I have broken the law and am aware that I am eluding justice.

4 I was traumatized by being forced to commit a crime as a child.

5 I'm unable to distinguish between the letter and the spirit of the law.

6 I wish I had joined the siege publicly, but I fear they'd never accept me.

Creator's note

The purpose of this document is to provide some backgrounds that are setting appropriate to the colonists of Roanoke. They are not a requirement. More information on 5th edition backgrounds may be found here: https://www.d20srd.org/index.htm